

TASK 01: SELF PORTRAIT



Extract from self-portrait painting 'The Broken Column' By Frida Kahlo.
Museo Dolores Olmedo, Mexico City.

1.1 INTRODUCTION

In designing space, architects seek to understand the nature of the Brief, the context of the site and the various users who will inhabit that space. Truly understanding these elements takes careful research and deep observation.

The origins of the architectural response will often start through formulation of a unique and abstract interpretation of the conditions discovered, leading to a concept to drive and encompass the design from large scale (such as composition and massing), to small scale (texture and materiality). It is only through 'knowing' that an appropriate abstract or conceptual approach can be formulated and ultimately realised in a successful design. Knowing is born of 'reflection'.

When you analyse a Brief or site, or prepare drawings, it is essential to reflect and ask yourself: Is this relevant? Does this communicate the message clearly?

You have no doubt achieved much leading to your decision to study architecture, and may have faced numerous challenges. You will have concerns for the present and aspirations for the future. In this assessment, you are to demonstrate the ability to reflect, by reflecting on yourself. **You are to prepare an abstract self-portrait to communicate where you have come from, where you are, where you hope to be; and present it to your peer group.**

'The greatest wisdom is to get to know oneself.'

- Galileo

2.1 SELF PORTRAIT

2.2 TASKS AND SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

2.3 Presentation Format:

- A single A2 Sheet. Portrait format. Note 'Portrait format' means orientate A2 sheet vertically as opposed to horizontally (landscape format).
- OR
- An abstract physical model.

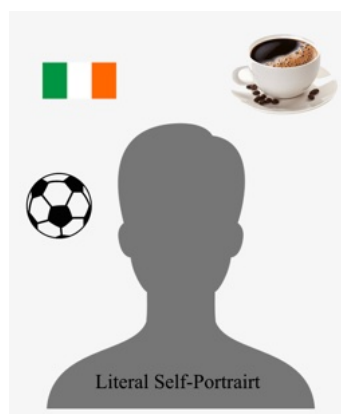


2.4 Medium:

- The medium you deem most suitable to convey your message. Including pencil/watercolour/paint/pastels/charcoals/collage/three-dimensional model or a mixture of same.

2.5 Presentation Specification:

- You are to prepare an abstract self-portrait to communicate where you have come from, where you are, and where you hope to be.
- Please note, **a literal or Impressionist self-portrait is 'skin deep' and does not demonstrate your ability for self-reflection** (see below example). This self-portrait must be abstract.



Please do not prepare a literal self-portrait and arrange isolated items of interest around that portrait.

- Carefully determine the imagery by which you will communicate your self-portrait. Consider your *narrative*. Consider your *composition*. Consider your *execution*.
- Prepare an appropriate 3 minute verbal presentation and present your self-portrait to your peer group.

2.6 Learning Outcomes Assessed:

- Students should:
 - 1. Gain an awareness of visual elements and their application in a variety of real world contexts.
 - 2. Demonstrate an ability to gather, observe, generate and reflect upon visual information.
 - 3. Show experience in the use of a variety of drawing media and approaches.
 - 4. Have acquired skills in communication and expression through visual and plastic forms.
 - 5. Demonstrate awareness of convergent and divergent thinking.

2.7 Presentation and Review Date:

The Formative Assessment Review of Task 1 will take place on Tuesday the 29th of September 2026 at 2pm in your Year Studios. Ensure your work is placed on wall in an ordered arrangement using magnets/masking tape. Before you present your work, plan and think carefully about how it will look and communicate.

All students must respectfully attend each Review. The use of mobile phones during Studio Workshops and Reviews is strictly prohibited. Disruptive behaviour will not be tolerated.

2.8 Selected Examples:

See following pages for selected examples from past students.

